

Developing Soft Skills and Personality



Professor T. Ravichandran

Department of Humanities and Social Sciences, IIT Kanpur

Week 2
Module 1
Lecture 7

Conflict Resolution Skills

Win-Win Solution

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



- David McClelland: 3 needs
- Affiliation, Power and Achievement
- The desire to excel: N-Ach
- PQ, IQ, EQ & SQ
- Danah Zohar's Spiritual Intelligence
- 12 Underlying principles
- Act from higher motivations
- Live life as a project with sensitivity towards Goodness, Truth and Beauty
- Self-awareness
- Spontaneity
- Being vision- and value-led:
- Holism
- Compassion
- Celebration of diversity
- Field independence
- Humility
- Tendency to ask fundamental "Why?" questions
- Ability to reframe
- Positive use of adversity
- Sense of vocation

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What is Conflict?



- 1. to come into collision or disagreement; be contradictory, at variance, or in opposition; clash:
- 2. to fight or contend; do battle.
- 3. a fight, battle, or struggle, esp. a prolonged struggle; strife.
- 4. controversy; quarrel: conflicts between parties.
- 5. discord of action, feeling, or effect; antagonism or opposition, as of interests or principles: a conflict of ideas.
- 6. a striking together; collision.

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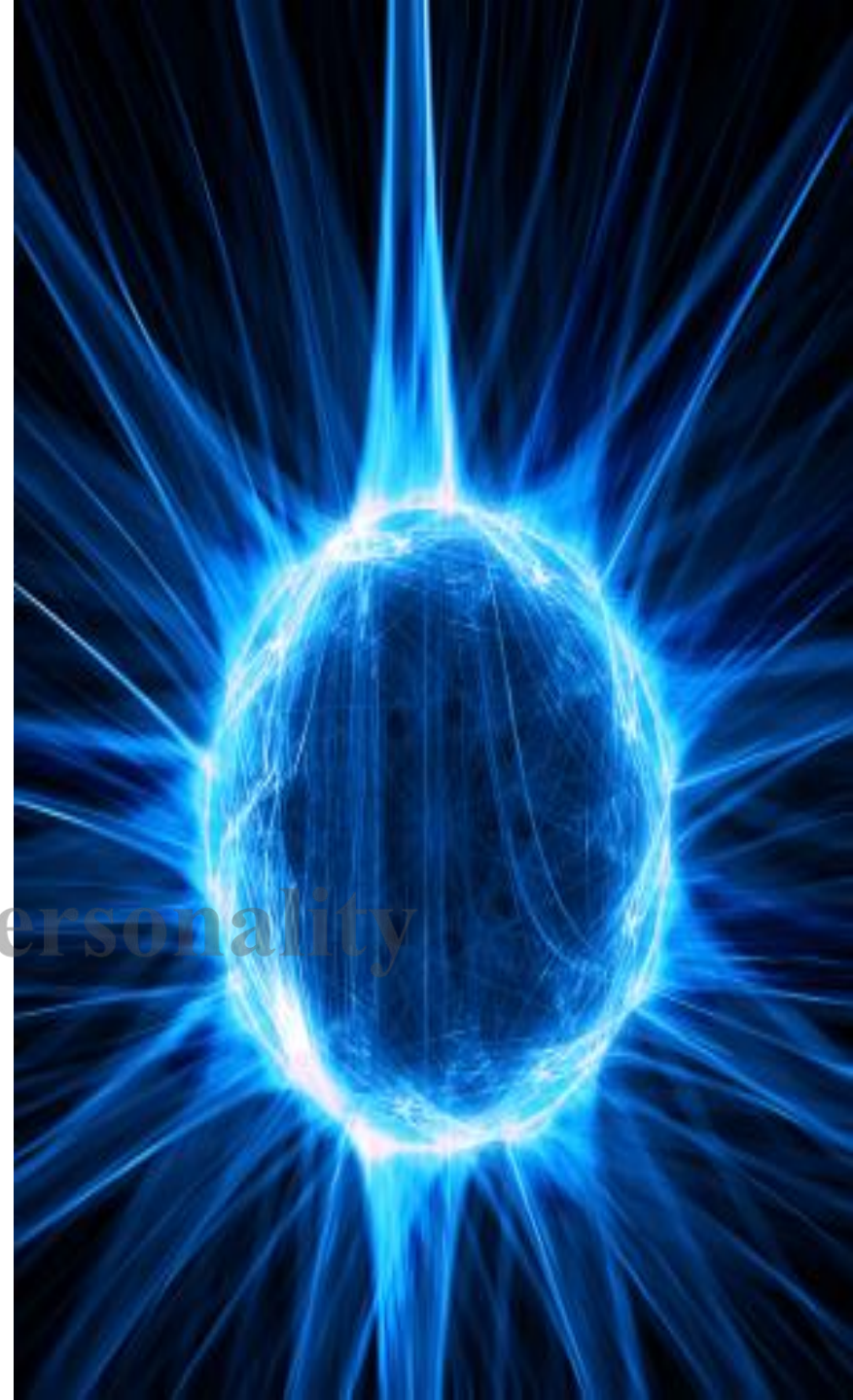
Conflict is...

- a normal, accepted, expected, inescapable part of life
- Everyone faces conflict in their lives on a daily basis.
- a periodic occurrence in any relationship
- an opportunity to understand opposing preferences and values



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Destructive or Constructive?

Resolving Conflict



Resolving Conflict

Destructive

- Disagreement about personality and character
- Attacks individuals
- Personal antagonism fueled by difference of opinion
- Destructive to group progress and cohesion
- Characteristic of low performers

• Constructive

- Disagreement about ideas and approaches
- Issue focused
- Respects differences tries to resolve without hurting personal sentiments
- Constructive and ensures group performance and cohesion
- Characteristic of High performers

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Escalating Eliminating conflicts?

Escalating

- Showing anger, threatening
- Hitting, throwing things
- Shouting, Yelling
- Using abusive words
- Insulting, ridiculing
- Being rigid & refusing to change or compromise
- Refusing to discuss and arrive at a solution
- Protesting, walking out

Eliminating

- Being calm and collected
- Keeping anger in control
- Avoiding personal attacks
- Agreeing to the extent possible
- Being flexible and willing to change and compromise
- Looking for a win-win solution
- Persisting patiently till the conflict is resolved



What to Say and Not to Say?

Not to Say

- I am right, but you are wrong
- What you say is true, BUT ...
- I should WIN in this, but you should LOSE
- You are responsible
- You should apologise
- You never listen
- You always do this

To Say

- You are right, but I am not wrong
- What you say is true, AND
- Let's find a WIN-WIN solution
- I own responsibility
- I am sorry, if I have hurt you or made this mistake
- I am listening
- I promise not to repeat

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What resolves
conflicts?

- **Negotiation**
- **Mediation**
- **Looking at both sides**
- **A Win-Win attitude**

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3 Levels of Conflict Resolution

1. **Negotiating** - two individuals sit down and work out a resolution together
2. **Mediation** – a third party assists individuals in finding a solution
3. **Arbitration** – involves a third party and is instituted when negotiations and mediations fail
 - [(Law) the hearing and determination of a dispute by an impartial referee agreed to by both parties (often used to settle disputes between labour and management)]
 - Arbiter: gives authoritative judgment

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Harmonise Relationships using Win-Win Problem Solving



*No life is lived without conflicts
Every relationship will face conflicting situations
at some point or other*

*When we are able to resolve internal and interpersonal conflicts,
using win-win problem solving, it strengthens the relationship.*

when we don't, it destroys it.

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*Peace comes not from
the absence of conflicts
But from the ability to
cope up with it.*

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Week 2
Module 2
Lecture 8

Conflict Resolution Skills

Inter-personal Conflicts

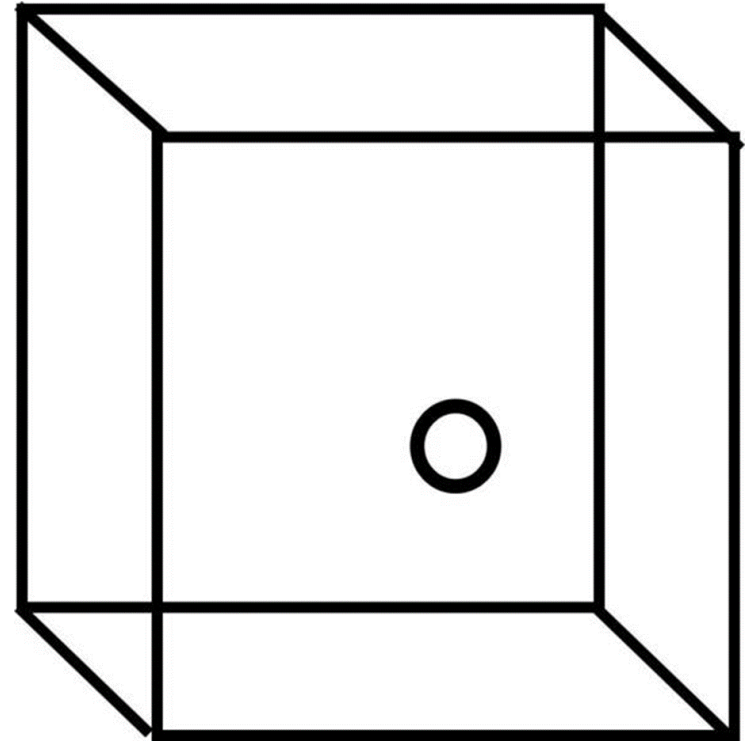
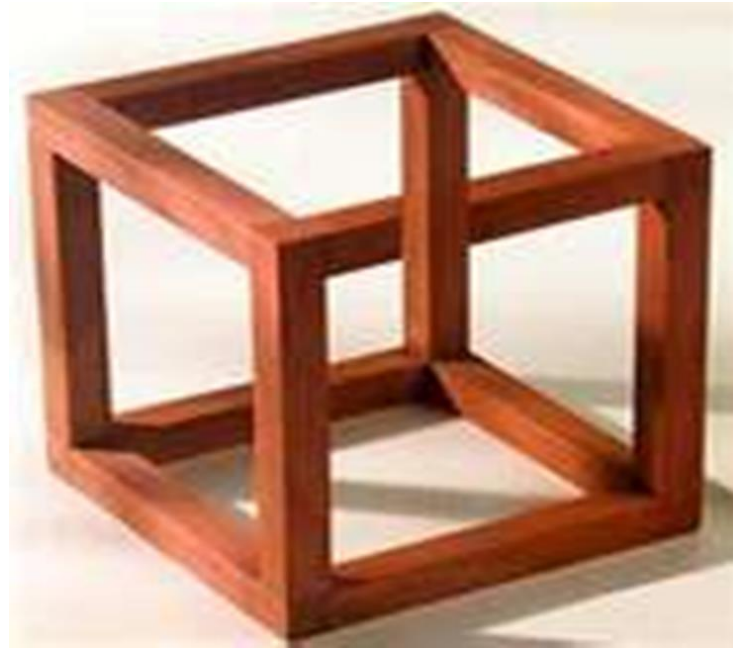
Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



- Conflicts—
disagreements, struggles, fights as part of life
- Destructive or constructive ways of resolving conflicts
- What to say and not say
- Escalate / Eliminate conflicts
- 3 levels: Negotiation, Mediation, Arbitration
- A Win-Win attitude
- Peace & harmony comes by solving the conflicts

Looking at
Both Sides





Conflict Resolution Skills & Process

- Choosing a conducive environment
- Brainstorming
- Getting the facts
- Active/Reflective Listening
- Focusing on the problem, not the person
- Defusing/managing anger
- Avoiding communication blockers
- Empathy skills
- Cognitive restructuring (*Cognition: The psychological result of perception and learning and reasoning*)
- Negotiating outcomes
- Choosing a solution that works for everybody



Inter-personal Conflict: Example 1

- **1.** Shilpa and Kishore loved each other for three years. They waited till Kishore got a good job and got married despite the opposition from both the families. They were happy to move to Mumbai for Kishore's job. But after one year of marriage, Kishore has become uncommunicative. He comes home late from work and wants to be left alone in front of the TV to unwind. Shilpa feels excluded. She realizes that Kishore has become self-centred and is unconcerned about her well-being. She has been wondering whether she should file for divorce. You are their neighbour and a trusted family friend. How would you stop Shilpa from filing for divorce and make Kishore communicative and caring?



Inter-personal Conflict: Example 2

- *Son:* Dad, you promised me to take me for a foreign trip this summer?
- *Father:* Yes, I did, if you get 10 point CPI.
- *Son:* But, I have got 9.6. That's close enough.
- *Father:* But, it doesn't make it 10 kid!
- *Son:* You are so mean dad!
- *Father:* So mean to a loser! Look at Aditya, he has secured 10 point throughout!
- *Son:* But his dad loves him always and supports him. You hate me dad! You love only your daughter, not me!
- *Father:* That's unfair after all I have done for you! I used all my savings to pay the fees for your college! You ungrateful dog! (*In his anger, he slaps him*).
- *Son:* (*Cries*) You will never understand me dad, never . . . I hate you! I am leaving home, right now!
- As the mother to the son, how would you stop him and make both the father and son understand each other?

Win-Win Solution



- **Remember:**
 - When you are able to provide win-win solution,
- **There is an intense feeling of mutual respect**
- **Love grows deeper with every conflict resolved.**

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Week 2
Module 3
Lecture 9

Conflict Resolution Skills

Inter-Personal Conflicts-Solutions

Highlights

Highlights
of the
Last Lecture



- **Resolving Conflicts—**
Looking at both sides
Giving contingency to the third side!
Conflict Resolution Skills & Process
- **Two Conflict Situations**
 1. **Husband-Wife**
 2. **Father-Son**

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Conflict Resolution Skills & Process

- Choosing a conducive environment
- Brainstorming
- Getting the facts
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Bertrand Russell, "Knowledge and Wisdom"

- . . . consider the case of two men, Mr A and Mr B, who hate each other and, through mutual hatred, bring each other to destruction. Suppose you go to Mr A and say, "Why do you hate Mr B?" He will no doubt give you an appalling list of Mr B's vices, partly true, partly false. And now suppose you go to Mr B. He will give you an exactly similar list of Mr A's vices with an equal admixture of truth and falsehood. Suppose you now come back to Mr A and say, "You will be surprised too learn that Mr B says the same things about you as you say about him," and you go to Mr B and make a similar speech. The first effect, no doubt, will be to increase their mutual hatred, since each will be so horrified by the other's injustice.
- But perhaps, if you have sufficient patience and sufficient persuasiveness, you may succeed in convincing each that the other has only the normal share of human wickedness, and that their enmity is harmful to both.
- If you can do this, you will have instilled some fragment of wisdom.





Inter-personal Conflict: Solution 1

- Choosing a conducive environment

Invite Shilpa & Kishore to your home, or a picnic to their favourite place, restaurant

- Defusing/managing anger

Make them play games (Truth or Dare), give them a team task (doubles in tennis)

- Brainstorming

May not work, if they are not willing to participate

- Getting the facts (Russell Method)

Make them list out five things they like in each other; and five they dislike;
Qs: Why did you marry against opposition? Why don't you share the problems at job? What do you do at home? How do you feel in the long absence of Kishore?

- Active/Reflective Listening

Listen to what they have to tell about each other and who triggered the conflict

- Focusing on the problem, not the person

Identify how you can stop the divorce; do not take sides or approve of one-sided blames



Inter-personal Conflict: Solution 1

- Avoiding communication blockers

Do not let them shout at each other or say “Shut up” “You never understand me” etc.

- Empathy skills

Make both feel that you are clearly understanding their problems and you are there to help them;

Shilpa can empathise with his job stress; Kishore on her lonely feeling

- Cognitive restructuring (*Cognition: The psychological result of perception and learning and reasoning*)

You can reconstruct the entire episode of conflict into a game like situation where you take suggestions from them for identifying the triggers and removing them. Bring back the trust and love.

- Negotiating outcomes

Discuss with them the outcomes of separation, and the benefits of living together

- Choosing a solution that works for everybody

1. Making Shilpa go to her friend's or parents home 2. Making Kishore take a break from job 3. Help them plan for travel together 4. They decide to help each other and live together. 5. Plan for a baby.



Inter-personal Conflict: Solution 2

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Inter-personal Conflict: Example 2

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- As the mother to the son, how would you stop him and make both the father and son understand each other?



- Choosing a conducive environment (temple, mall)
- Brainstorming (sitting together, and planning for a vacation)
- Getting the facts (knowing who said what)
- Active/Reflective Listening (listen to both)
- Focusing on the problem, not the person (take the kid for a trip)
- Defusing/managing anger (by love and concern)
- Avoiding communication blockers (not letting them blame)
- Empathy skills (make them know you feel their pain)
- Cognitive restructuring (tell them how better the situation could have been avoided: stopping comparison, Is CPI more important than son's well-being?)
- Negotiating outcomes (going out, staying at home; going to Ladakh)
- Choosing a solution that works for everybody (live at the home with proper understanding, saying sorry, hugging)

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Win-Win Solution



- **Remember:**
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Week 2
Module 4
Lecture 10

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



- Discussed solutions to two conflicts at inter-personal level

Looking at both sides

Giving contingency to the third side!

- Bertrand Russell's approach to instilling wisdom

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Other ways of Resolving Conflicts

Demanding SOLUTION

- **Sister:** *(to her brother who is playing music loudly and dancing with his friends)* Monkeys! Can't you go out and jump and babble on trees? I need a peaceful atmosphere.
- **Brother:** You goose, we are just freaking out, you can find a peaceful place yourself!

Emphasising NEED

- **Sister:** Hey guys! Nice Music! I need a quite atmosphere because I am preparing for my exam tomorrow . . .
- **Brother (and friends):** We will leave soon and you can work in peace!



Other ways of Resolving Conflicts

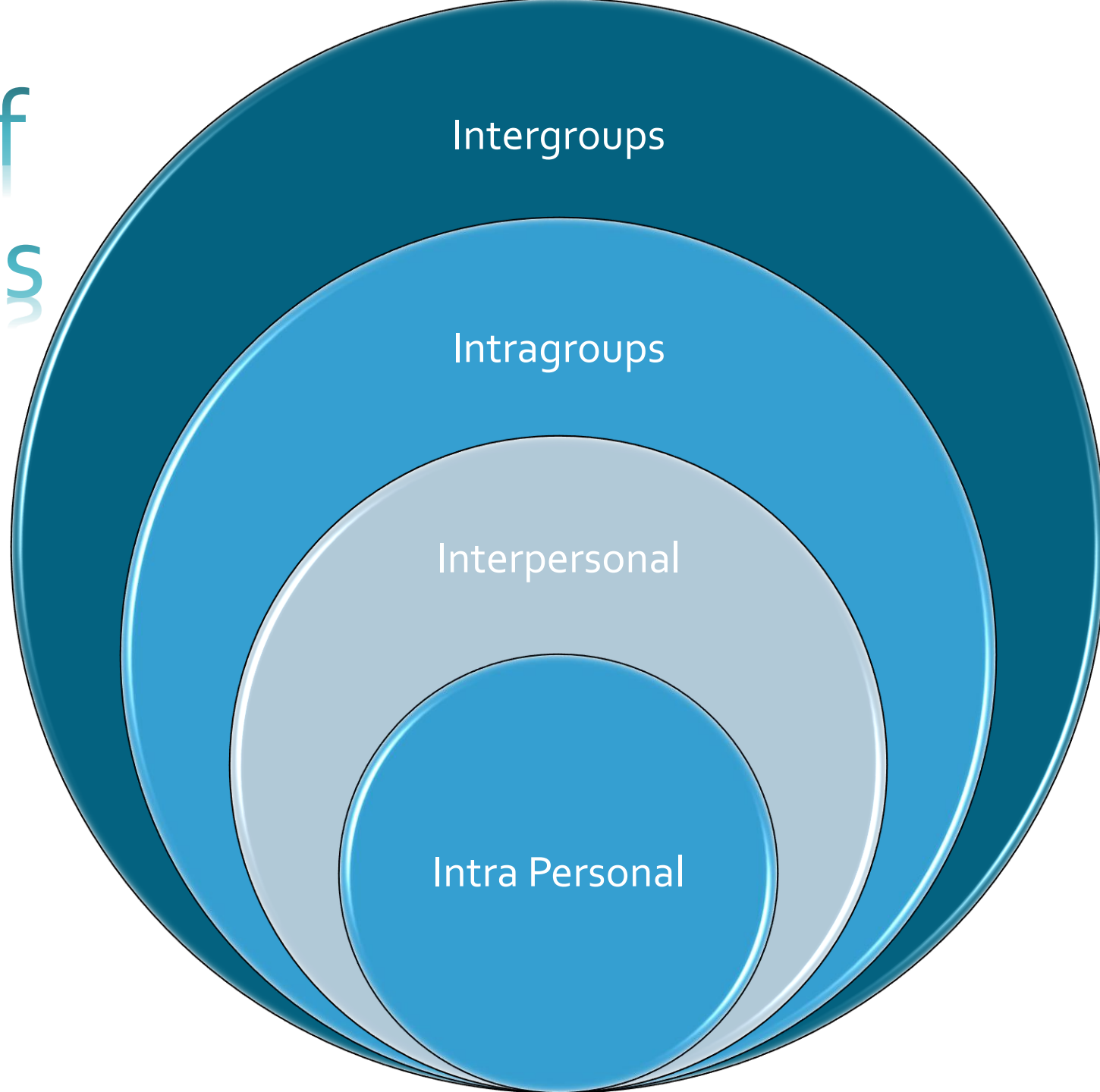
Demanding SOLUTION

- **Wife: (to her husband) I like it calm. Can't you switch off the TV and do something meaningful?**
- **Husband: But, my favourite program is going on, it will take time. Why don't you go upstairs?**

Emphasising NEED

- **Wife: To do my Yoga I need a calm place.**
- **Husband: (1) OK I will switch off the TV and read that novel. (2) OK. I will use the Bluetooth headphone (3) I will just leaving for jogging now. (4) Never mind, I can watch the program on the internet later!**

Types of Conflicts





ME

Toughest conflict resolution skills are needed for dealing with intra-personal ones!

Leaves one with the psychological dilemma whether or not to do a thing.

To get up or not to get up?

To brush your teeth or not to before having a cup of tea?

To go for a morning walk or not?

To talk to some one or not?

To take bath or not?

To complete that long pending work or not?

To stop procrastination or not?

To give up laziness or not?

To become successful or not?

To become a self-actualized individual or not?

Should I continue with this course or not?



Why conflicts are seen in negative perspective?

- **ANGER:** When somebody gets angry, s/he intimidates others. When an angry father **threatens** to beat the mother, children become very **anxious**.
- Often people cause conflicts by acting on psychologically perceived **threats**.
- People generally don't like **disagreements**; they lose their love and affection to people who keep disagreeing with them constantly. They will either avoid or turn **hostile**.

How can a conflict be positive?

- A well-resolved conflict has the potential to bring out **productive** results
- Conflicts can be used positively for **Clarifying, Learning**, and for promoting a **stimulating environment**.
- It can help in **strengthening** relationships and foster **intimate bonds**.
- At a person level, one can emerge **courageous**.
- In workplace, **creative solutions** can be arrived at.
- In intra/interpersonal conflicts, it can be helpful in **enriching and developing new ties and friendships**.
- In intra-group conflicts, the group becomes more **caring and inclusive**
- Overall, conflicts are **opportunities for growth** and overcoming hurdles towards reaching excellence.

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Resolving Types



- **Avoiding (Shy, introverts, peace-makers)**
- **Accommodating (unassertive, cooperative, relationships first)**
- **Attacking (Aggressive, Powerful, dominating)**
- **Collaborating (assertive and cooperative, seek win-win)**
- **Competing (win-lose, non-cooperative, own concerns)**
- **Compromising (sacrificing, seeking harmony, lose-lose)**

Become Conflict- Resolution Expert



- Embrace Conflicts
- Look for conflicts and test your abilities to resolve them
- Help friends and colleagues
- Gently interfere in unknown situations
- *Use conflicts as opportunities to develop your personality and strengthen human relationships!*

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Week 2
Module 5
Lecture 11

Types of Stress

Self-Awareness About Stress

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



- Discussed other ways of resolving conflicts.
- Emphasising **NEED** instead of Demanding **SOLUTION**
- Types of Conflicts: Intra/Interpersonal and Intra/Intergroup
- Toughest is the intrapersonal one
- Why conflicts are seen in a negative perspective?
- Why you need to see it in a positive perspective?

Essential for increase in productivity, intimacy in relationships and growth for self.

- Resolving Types: Avoiding, Accommodating, Attacking Collaborating, Competing, Compromising
- Becoming an expert: Embrace conflicts, test your abilities resolve them.
- Conflicts are hidden opportunities to strengthen your personality and develop harmonious relationships—two aspects which are important for your personal as well as professional success.



Do get irritated with others, sometimes for no reason?

Do you get head ache frequently?

Do you reduce/increase weight suddenly (eating/not-eating)?

Do you fall sick so often?

Do you take time to recuperate?

Sometimes do you just shout at people?

Are you getting sound sleep at night?

Do you lose keys, pens, mobiles often?

Are not able to concentrate on work?

Do you lose interest in people?

Are you afraid of meeting some people?

Do you feel annoyed when you have to respond to so many e-mails and phonecalls?

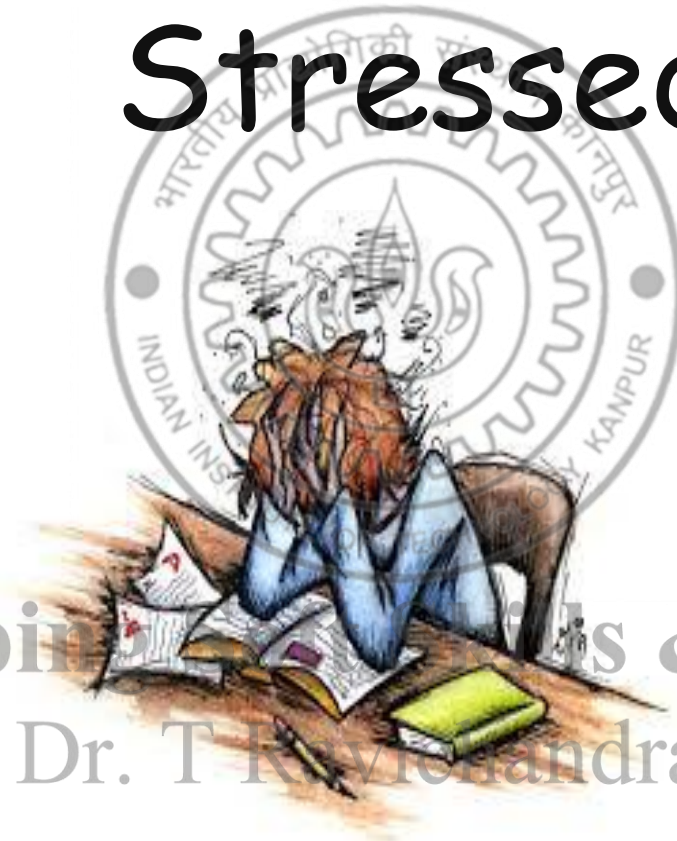
Do you get moody frequently?

If your answer is YES to most of the questions,
Then you are . . .



You are Stressed!

Stress is
Mental pressure,
emotional worry,
physical strain caused
due to imbalance
between situational
demands and
individual's ability to
handle it.



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What is stress?

Imagine a situation that you will have to reach the airport in an hour. But before that you need to sign on 50 files, talk to 10 people, wait for someone to finish a task, on the way your car is moving slowly in the traffic jam . . .

meanwhile, your wife is unwell and wants to know whether you have some time to go with her to the hospital.

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more questions? ?

Do only human beings get stressed?



more questions? ?

Do only certain types of human beings get stressed?

Type A



Type B



Type AB



Is Stress Bad or Good?



- Certain stress is necessary to warm you up
- Man is inherently lazy
- Parkinson's Law: "Work expands so as to fill the time available for its completion."
- Stress is needed for breaking the inertia and getting into the flow
- Good Stress: Eustress

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Good Stress Eustress



- Positive
- Pumps in adrenalin
- Makes you focussed & determined
- Master of Eleventh hour
- Find creative ways of solving a problem; experience peaks
- Eg: A better job in a foreign country, getting married, achieving a challenging target





Bad Stress *Distress*

- Causes your fear, anger, apprehension, worry, tension has a negative impact on your body or mind
- Haste makes waste: Many mistakes are likely to happen
- Sometimes more than the estimated amount of time will be required.
- Risk of leaving a work incomplete or submitting an imperfect work can leave one with added stress.
- Can disrupt the routine: eating (more or less, untimed); sleeping
- Unregulated stress can lead to mental depression and other psychological problems;
- physical ill health such as BP, heart attack, stroke, piles, ulcer, cancer, etc.

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"It's not stress
that kills us, it
is our reaction
to it."

- Hans Selye

*The major cause of stress
is the inability of people to
discover their real nature.*

**Discover your gifts,
follow them and you
will never feel stressed**

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Week 2
Module 6
Lecture 12

Regulating Stress

Make the best out of stress!

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



- Caused self-awareness about stress
- Stress is an imbalance between situational demand and individual supply.
- All people, all living things get stressed.
- Good stress (Eustress) and Bad Stress (Distress)

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Why should you regulate stress?

- Some are more cheerful and relaxed than others, at home or at work. Why?
- Many people have died due to stress.
- Those who have survived have emerged as strong leaders and saved mankind from man-made or natural disasters.
- As Nietzsche said, what doesn't kill you, makes you stronger!
- High bps, heart attacks, diabetes, Nervous breakdowns can be handled if stress is regulated!

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When Stress is Regulated

- you complete tasks easier and better; create time for other jobs or just to relax with family or friends.
- You will stay calm even in testing times;
- people won't know whether you are undergoing stress or not.

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Regulating Stress

- **Regulating:** Not beating or killing
- **Governing, modulating, controlling, directing**
- **Manage Environment:**
- **home, office, education, general surroundings, colleagues, lifestyle**

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Regulating Stress

(Governing, modulating, controlling, directing)

- Personal health habits: Keeping fit
- Sleeping 7 to 8 hours
- Exercise for 45 minutes
- Yoga or meditation
- Eating healthy food in time
- Mindfulness: committed fully to what you are doing
- Being mindful while bathing or sipping tea
- Plan the work, and work the plan
- Break from work



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Mastering Stress

- Master first the intrapersonal level stresses by maintaining healthy habits
- Try to regulate inter-personal/intra/inter group stresses
- Identify individuals or groups with stress
- Give suggestions, tell them jokes, share your experience, make them talk, laugh...

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Stress Regulating (not managing or beating)

- Shower (hot or cold)
- Talking to a friend
- Walk in a natural setting
- Listening to favourite/soothing music
- Deep breathing
- Watching a favourite movie
- Reading a favourite novel, or pages from motivating book
- Going to a temple
- Shopping in a mall
- Eating your favourite food
- Laughing

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Stress management is life management. If you take control of your stress, your life will thank you for it!

– Stress Management Coach Shereka Dunston